KHAYALETHU XOLISWA NGEMA

Resident Companionship & Recreation Volunteer
Durban, KwaZulu-Natal, South Africa
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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Compassionate, patient and dependable individual with a strong interest in supporting elderly residents through meaningful companionship, social interaction and recreational activities. Strong communication and active-listening abilities with a respectful approach to working with older adults.

Experienced in supporting community activities involving conversation, games, reading, music and group interaction. Able to encourage participation while respecting individual preferences, dignity and personal boundaries. Reliable team member who understands the importance of following safety procedures, maintaining privacy and reporting concerns to supervising staff.

Seeking to contribute these qualities as a **Resident Companionship & Recreation Volunteer at SwiftCare**.

CORE SKILLS

- Resident Companionship & Social Support
- Communication & Active Listening
- Empathy & Compassion
- Patience & Understanding
- Elderly Resident Interaction
- Recreational Activities
- Board & Card Games
- Reading & Storytelling
- Music & Social Activities
- Arts & Creative Activities
- Teamwork & Collaboration
- Reliability & Punctuality
- Safety Awareness
- Privacy & Confidentiality

- Professional Conduct
- Responsible Reporting

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Community Companionship & Elderly Support Volunteer

Durban Community Volunteer Activities | 2024 – Present

- Provide friendly companionship and positive social interaction to older community members.
- Engage participants in respectful conversations while using active listening and patience.
- Assist with games, reading, music, storytelling and other suitable recreational activities.
- Encourage residents and community members to participate in activities according to their interests and comfort levels.
- Help create welcoming, inclusive and positive social environments.
- Work with other volunteers to organise and support community activities.
- Respect personal boundaries and maintain confidentiality when individuals share personal information.
- Follow safety instructions and report concerns to the appropriate responsible person.
- Demonstrate reliability by attending scheduled activities and completing assigned responsibilities.

Community Activities Assistant

Durban Community Recreation Support | 2023 – 2024

- Assisted with recreational and social activities for community members.
- Helped organise board games, reading sessions, music activities and group discussions.
- Encouraged positive interaction and participation among individuals.
- Supported people who required additional encouragement or assistance.
- Communicated clearly and respectfully with participants.
- Worked as part of a team to prepare activity areas and materials.
- Maintained a safe, organised and respectful environment.
- Demonstrated patience when assisting individuals who needed additional time or explanation.

EDUCATION

National Senior Certificate

KwaZulu-Natal, South Africa | 2023

Relevant areas of development included communication, personal development, social responsibility, teamwork and community participation.

RELEVANT TRAINING

Introduction to Elderly Care & Companionship

Community Care Development Programme | 2024

Training included respectful communication, active listening, empathy, resident dignity, social engagement, recreational activities, safety awareness, privacy and responsible reporting.

Basic First Aid Awareness

Community Safety & First Aid Training | 2024

Developed basic awareness of first-aid principles, emergency response, personal safety and recognising situations requiring additional assistance.

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ROLE-SPECIFIC STRENGTHS

Companionship:
Enjoys engaging older adults through friendly conversation, reading, games, music and other appropriate social activities.

Empathy & Patience:
Able to interact calmly and compassionately with people who may have different communication styles, personalities and needs.

Communication:
Communicates respectfully and clearly while adapting conversations to individual preferences.

Active Listening:
Pays attention to residents' concerns, interests and experiences and allows them to express themselves comfortably.

Teamwork:
Comfortable working alongside nurses, care staff, volunteers and other team members.

Reliability:
Committed to punctuality, scheduled responsibilities and completing assigned tasks properly.

Safety & Privacy:
Understands the importance of following staff instructions, resident-care procedures, safety requirements and confidentiality expectations.

RECREATIONAL ACTIVITIES

Able to assist with:

- Board and card games
- Reading and storytelling
- Music and singing activities
- Arts and crafts
- Group conversations
- Social gatherings
- Memory and conversation games
- Simple creative activities
- Resident interest-based activities

SWIFTCARE ROLE ALIGNMENT

Position: Resident Companionship & Recreation Volunteer
Category: Companionship
Volunteer Area: Activities & Recreation
Location: Durban, KwaZulu-Natal
Volunteer Period: 21 October 2026 – 21 October 2027
Availability: 08:00 – 14:00

Contribution to SwiftCare

- Provide friendly and respectful companionship to residents.

- Encourage meaningful conversation and social interaction.
- Assist with approved recreational activities.
- Support reading, games, music, arts and group activities.
- Encourage residents to participate while respecting their individual preferences.
- Help create a positive and welcoming environment.
- Communicate resident concerns to the supervising nurse or assigned staff member.
- Follow SwiftCare safety, privacy, conduct and resident-care guidelines.
- Work cooperatively with the wider SwiftCare team.
- Maintain professional boundaries and respect resident dignity.

PERSONAL ATTRIBUTES

Compassionate • Patient • Respectful • Friendly • Dependable • Trustworthy • Approachable • Responsible • Team-oriented • Positive • Adaptable • Willing to Learn

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REFERENCES

Available upon request.

DECLARATION

I am committed to providing respectful, compassionate and reliable support to older adults and contributing positively to their daily social and recreational experience at SwiftCare.

Khayalethu Xoliswa Ngema
Durban, KwaZulu-Natal